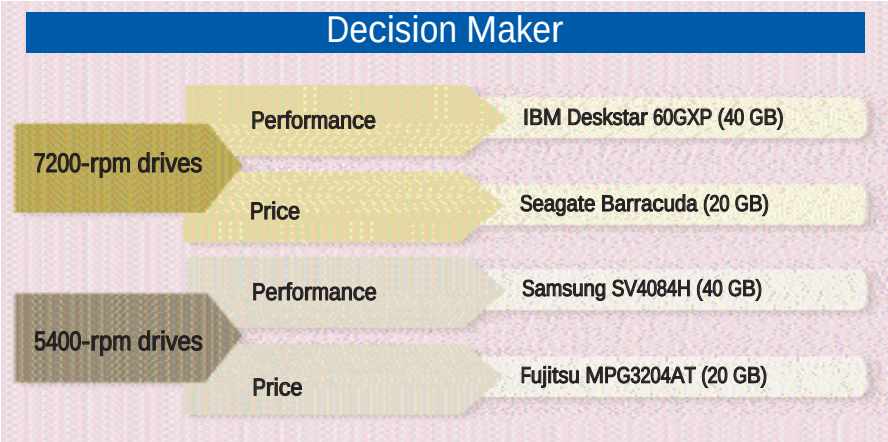




price as well as performance, that choosing the best from them is very closely tied in to the utilisation.

In the 7200-rpm category, the drive that bagged the Best Performance award was the **40 GB IBM DeskStar 60GXP**. This drive posted best-of-class performance in virtually all of the tests it was subjected to and is ideally suited for applications that need high speed data transfer such as professional audio and video editing or even for the



Seagate Barracuda: the value option

demanding home user. The drive bagging the Best Value award in this category was the **20 GB Seagate Barracuda ST320414A**. The drive was priced nearly the same as most 5400-rpm drives (though offering only 20 GB of storage space) and if it is performance you're looking for but don't need an overly high amount of storage space, there's no other drive that comes close to the 20 GB Barracuda.

In the 5400-rpm category, the drive that bagged top honours was the **40 GB Samsung SV4084H**. This drive offered a good amount of storage space for working with most applications and posted very good performance characteristics. If you're looking for good value where you do not need much storage space or especially high per-

formance, the **20 GB Fujitsu MPG3204AT** should suffice, with its reasonable performance and highly affordable price. This drive is ideal if all you're looking for is an economically priced hard disk for running applications such as word processors, spreadsheets and surfing the Internet.

With hard disk drives pushing the limits of performance and capacities and with applications getting larger every day, it wouldn't be surprising if in a few months, you were to settle for a 60 GB or 100 GB hard disk in your new home computer.



Samsung SV4084H: impressive performance



Fujitsu MPG3204AT: an affordable performer

Until then, the present drives will serve you well in whatever application you might want to throw at them—be it office productivity or serious gaming!

1/4th AD